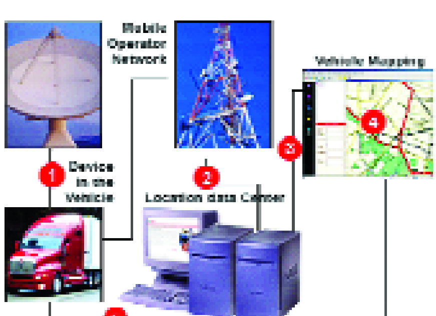
cycles, and enable timely delivery, resulting in delivering better service.

Taking advantage of this, MobiApps, a Bangalore-based provider of hybrid terrestrial and satellite technologies for commercial communications has developed a mobile vehicle tracking system, which helps track, manage, access, and monitor all your trucks or other mobile assets developed m-Trak, an online asset-tracking solution that has been designed to support logistics and transportation.

m-Trak provides real-time information on fixed and mobile assets. It helps address issues such as tracking, monitoring, managing, and communicating with all mobile assets in real-time. m-Trak integrates GPS technology, mobile telephony (GSM), and the Internet, to provide a solution that addresses these key challenges with real-time, location-relevant, and time-sensitive information. The m-Trak system helps receive alerts from the assets, track assets on map, generate reports, replay routes, and communicate with the asset drivers.

m-Trak is available in three variants: m-Trak 50, m-Trak 75, and m-Trak 100. m-Trak 100 helps fleet managers pinpoint the location of their vehicles, provide information about over-speeding vehicles, unscheduled stops and a host of other in-vehicle conditions. It streamlines the management of fleets by providing reports and analyses of vehicle journeys, and provides complete journey records for all vehicles. This helps in planning, tracking, and scheduling. It also assists fleet managers to have better control over operations while enhancing value-added services to their customers.

How It Works



What Does It Do?

The m-Trak system is a real-time vehicle tracking system with a tamper-proof unit having a built-in keyboard and a LCD panel. It can show the real-time position of the vehicle or play back the vehicle's travel path on a digital map. The information will include the current location of the vehicle, distance travelled, vehicle speed, number of stops made, and the location and duration of the stops.

Its user interface enables two-way voice and text communication. It also has an external handset attachment for voice communication, an inbuilt address book, call-log facility, one-key predefined messages, built in GSM/SMS communications, optional RF wireless communication, and an optional SOS switch. It can be configured using a remote, can be customised to meet client-specific requirements, and is also capable of monitoring events occurring inside the vehicle.

m-Trak's functionality integrates a host of technologies. The GPS receiver determines the vehicle's location; after identifying the location, the information is sent via SMS to the fleet manager's control station. The m-Trak control station software then plots the vehicle's location on a display map, which can be viewed by the fleet manager. (*See infographic*)

The Technology Behind It

MobiApps has designed the m-Trak solution mainly around the Global Positioning System (GPS).

The GPS technology offers accurate information such as latitude, longitude, altitude, date and time, speed, moving direction, and distance (derived). In tangent with GPS, MobiApps also uses terrestrial wireless communication systems such as GSM and the Internet as the medium for user interaction.

MobiApps adopted GPS, as it is a worldwide radio navigation system based on a network of 24 satellites. These satellites determine the position of any object on earth, provided these objects have a GPS receiver. These GPS receivers